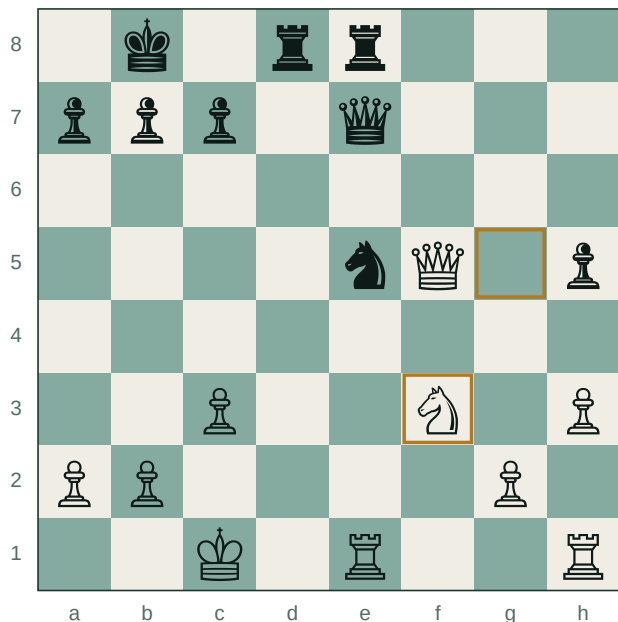


Forks and double attacks: Black, move 25

Forks and double attacks

Black to move



Previous move: 25.Nf3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

25...Nd3+ 26. Qxd3 Rxd3 27. Rxe7 Rxe7

25...Nd3+ Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. From d3 it attacks king on c1 and rook on e1. Recorded reply: **26.Qxd3**.

26...Rxd3 The rook captures the queen on d3. Recorded reply: **27.Rxe7**.

27...Rxe7 The rook captures the rook on e7.

At the end, nominal material is White 13 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +2: the balance goes from -1 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Two attacked pieces do not guarantee a gain if the forking piece can be captured or one target moves with check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A fork attacks multiple targets at once. The combination works when the defender cannot save everything or generate a stronger forcing reply.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for checking forks first, then double attacks on queens, rooks, and undefended pieces. Follow the line until the material is actually collected.

The defending king is on c1. Geometrically undefended: queen on f5. Check for tactical protection.